

Juan D. Soto Díaz

The University of Queensland
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Current Position

01/2024 –present *Research Fellow*, The University of Queensland, Australia

Affiliations

01/2024 –present School of Economics, The University of Queensland
01/2024 –present Sustainable Minerals Institute (SMI), The University of Queensland

Previous & Visiting Appointments

04/2023 – 04/2024 *Graduate Visiting Research Fellow*, London School of Economics (LSE), UK
09/2022 – 12/2023 *Lecturer in Economics (visiting)*, Universidad Católica del Norte, Chile
01/2022 – 04/2022 *Visiting PhD. Student*, Dept. of Economics, University College London (UCL), UK
09/2021 – 09/2022 *Subwarden (pastoral student support)*, LSE Bankside Hall, UK
05/2020 – 06/2020 *Short-Term Consultant*, Jobs and Development Group, World Bank, USA
04/2015 – 12/2017 *Research Economist*, Latin American Center for Rural Development, Chile

Education

Doctoral Studies

London School of Economics (LSE)
PhD. in Economic Geography (2018 – 2023)
DISSERTATION: “*Essays on Globalization, Commodities, and Local Economic Development*”
Specialization: International Trade, Spatial Economics, Resource and Environmental Economics

Prior Education

Universidad Católica del Norte (UCN – Chile).
BA. Business Management / MSc. Applied Economics (2008 – 2014)

Publications

Working Papers

Critical Raw Material Disruption and Technological Trajectories
with G.Y. Li (ShanghaiTech), X. Ye (University of Liverpool), and Y. Huang (University of Sussex)
Revise & Resubmit, *Research Policy* (ABDC A*)

Community-Based Initiatives and Local Business Dynamism
with A.-M. Opria (UAIC) and A. Rodríguez-Pose (LSE)

Developing Circular Economy Business Models for the Mining Industry
with Z. Longxiang (RHUL), S. Micklewaite (UQ), E. Marquis (Exeter), and K. Hudson-Edwards (Exeter)

Linkages and the Local Economic Impacts of Resource Booms

Commodity Price Shocks and Illicit Supply Chains: Evidence from the Amazon Gold Rush

Local Industrial Upgrading in Commodity Supply Chains: Lessons from the Copper Industry

Urbanization and the Optimal Routes to Structural Transformation

with M. Vargas and J. Berdegúe (Government of Mexico)

Journal Articles

The Economics of Mine Waste Reduction: The Case of Ore-Sand

(with S. Micklewaite, I. MacKenzie, J. Segura-Salazar, et al.)

Journal of Cleaner Production, 573(148930):1-18, 2026.

Technology, Geography, and Diversification in a Small Mineral Economy

(with M. Lufin)

The Extractive Industries and Society, 11:1-14, 2022.

Mining Linkages in the Copper Supply Network and Regional Economic Development

(with M. Atienza and M. Lufin)

Resources Policy, 70:1-12, 2021.

Wage Compensation for Fly-In/Fly-Out and Drive-In/Drive-Out Commuters

(with D. Paredes and D. Fleming)

Papers in Regional Science, 97(4):1337-1353, 2018.

Cities, Wages, and the Urban Hierarchy

(with D. Paredes)

Journal of Regional Science, 56(4):596-614, 2016.

(master's dissertation), Pacific Regional Science Conference Organization (PRSCO) Best Paper Award, Andrew Isserman Prize

Research Grants

2026–2029 CRC Transformation in Mining Economies (CRC-TiME), Australia
co-researcher, Principal Researcher: Corinne Unger (US\$ 350,000)
Project: “Regional Knowledge Exchange on Post-Mine Transitions”

2026 Minerals and Metals Group (MMG Australia Limited), Australia
co-researcher, Principal Researcher: Douglas Aitken (US\$ 85,000)
Project: “Botswana Copper Value Chain Analysis”

2025–2026 Department of Natural Resources (Queensland Government), Australia
co-researcher, Principal Researcher: Mark Noppe (US\$ 675,000)
Project: “Optimising Future Copper Production in NWMP” (Phase I, II, and III)

2025–2026 Department of Resources (Queensland Government), Australia
co-researcher, Principal Researcher: Juliana Segura-Salazar (US\$ 600,000)
Project: “Towards Zero Waste Mining”

2016–2019 National Fund for Scientific and Technological Development (FONDECYT), Chile
co-researcher, Principal Researcher: Julio Berdegúe (US\$ 125,000)
Project: “Cities and Development in Chile”

- 2016–2017 National Institute for Agricultural Development (INDAP), Chile
co-researcher, Principal Researcher: Julio Berdegúe (US\$ 180,000)
Project: “*Baseline for the Impact Evaluation of Rural Development Policies in Chile*”

Honours and Fellowships

- 2018–2022 Ph.D. Scholarship, National Commission for Scientific Research (Conicyt/ANID), Chile
- 2017 PRSCO Award for the Best Paper by a Young Regional Scientist, Taiwan
- 2014 Andrew Isserman Prize for Best Young Scholar Paper, SOCHER, Chile
- 2013–2014 Department of Economics Scholarship, UCN, M.Sc. Studies, Chile
- 2008–2012 Academic Excellence Scholarship, UCN, B.A. Studies, Chile
- 2008–2012 Scholarship Bicentenario, MINEDUC, B.A. Studies, Chile

Teaching Experience [\(see teaching evaluations here\)](#)

The University of Queensland (UQ)

- [ECON7720 Ecological and Environmental Economics](#) 2026 (2nd semester)
- [ECON3510 International Trade Theory and Policy](#) 2025 (1st semester)

Universidad Católica del Norte (UCN – Chile)

- EC695 Statistical Learning 2023 (2nd semester)
- EC200 Macroeconomics 2023 (2nd semester)
- EC301 Microeconomics 2023 (2nd semester)
- EC600 Industrial Organization 2014 (summer course)
- EC400 Econometrics, EC201/EC300 Statistics 2013 – 2014 (1st and 2nd semester)

Supervision

The University of Queensland (UQ)

- 2025 – 2026: Long Hoang (M.Phil. Economics, joint supervision with Dr. Jorge Miranda-Pinto)
- 2026 – : Martin Lynch (Ph.D. Mineral Economics, joint supervision with Prof. Rick Valenta)

Presentations

- 2025
- University of Exeter, Camborne School of Mines
 - The Chinese University of Hong Kong, HSS (CUHK-SZ)
 - Conference Workshop Australasian and Agricultural Resource Economics Society (AARES)
 - Resourcing Decarbonisation Showcase, Sustainable Minerals Institute (SMI-UQ)
 - The University of Queensland, School of Economics, Macroeconomics Group
- 2023
- Central Bank of Chile, Economics Research Department

References

Professor Ian MacKenzie
The University of Queensland (UQ)
i.mackenzie@uq.edu.au

Professor Riccardo Crescenzi
London School of Economics (LSE)
r.crescenzi@lse.ac.uk

Professor J. Vernon Henderson
London School of Economics (LSE)
j.v.henderson@lse.ac.uk

Dr. Jorge Miranda-Pinto
International Monetary Fund (IMF)
jmirandapinto@imf.org

Professor Andrés Rodríguez-Pose
London School of Economics (LSE)
a.rodriquez-pose@lse.ac.uk

Dr. Daria Taglioni
World Bank, Development Research Group
dtaglioni@worldbank.org

Computer Skills

STATA, R, Python, Matlab and ArcGIS

Personal

Born on March 12, 1988
Chilean Citizen
Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent)

Last updated: October 4, 2026
<https://juandanielsotodiaz.github.io/site/>